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Babur’s Rule in Samarkand

Babur had always dreamt of capturing Samarkand and the winters of AD 1497 had turned this dream into a reality.

Babur knew very well that he had to rule in a calculated manner and with perfection. Taking a wise diplomatic path, as soon as he sat on the throne, he bestowed equal favour and kindness over all the begs of Samarkand. Apart from that, he also gave ranks to the begs who were already with him based on the circumstances and goodwill. The largest share of his benevolence came to the lot of Sulṭān Ahmad Tambal who was raised to the ranks of one of the greatest begs, for he had always been loyal.

The town had come into Babur’s hands after seven months of tough seige led by Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā and him. But the hard challenges were set to march in soon. The land had been subjugated to raids and rapines for quite a few months already. The booty taken by Babur and his men too had come to an end. The town was in eager need of seed corn and money advances. There was nothing that Babur could take any further from the place, and he was not even able to give anything to the town. Babur’s men suffered major privation.

A lot of time had passed since they had been home. They had begun to yearn and the expressions on everyone’s face reflected the mood. Khān Quli ultimately happened to become the first to fly back. He was followed by Ibrahim Begchik. Soon all Moghūls rode back home. Sulṭān Ahmad Tambal was the last one to leave.

When everyone had left, a disappointed Babur sent Khwaja-i-Qazi to Auzun Hasan in Andijān as the latter was always seen as a faithful friend of the former. The intention was to put a stop to the ongoing desertions by putting sanctions and punishments. Babur wanted all to get back to Samarkand as soon as possible.